

WHY MEAL PLANNING IS NON-NEGOTIABLE IN CKD

THE 3 MAJOR DIETARY THREATS

1. Potassium Spike

Hyperkalemia causes fatal arrhythmia. K+ rises fast from bananas, kamote, kamatis, and all broths.

2. Phosphate Overload

Inorganic phosphate (additives) absorbed 90-100%. Causes vascular calcification, bone disease, and death.

3. Sodium/Fluid Overload

Hypertension, pulmonary edema, heart failure. Toyo, patis, bagoong, and fast food are the main culprits.

THE INORGANIC PHOSPHATE PROBLEM

Absorbed **90-100%** (vs 40-60% for natural food phosphate)

Found in additives **E338 to E452** on ingredient labels

Scan every label for the word "PHOS" — if present, skip it

The Ingredient Label Test:

1. Flip the package. Read ingredients.

2. Search for any word containing "PHOS"

3. Found one? Put it back. That food is unsafe.

4. No PHOS found? Check sodium and potassium next.

MEAL PREP IS A CLINICAL INTERVENTION

Batch cooking correlates with better serum phosphorus, potassium, and albumin control.

2-3 hours on Sunday = 7 days of kidney-protected eating.

This is part of your prescription — as important as your medications.

THE FILIPINO DIETARY CHALLENGE		
Food	Risk	Clinical Impact
Bagoong / Patis / Toyo	Concentrated Na+ + purines	Hypertension, hyperuricemia, fluid overload
Sinigang / Nilaga / Bulalo broth	High K+ + purines leach into liquid	Hyperkalemia, gout flares — skip all broth
Tocino / Longganisa / Hotdog	Phosphate preservatives + Na	Vascular calcification, hypertension
Beer + HFCS softdrinks	Raise serum uric acid	Gout flares, renal tubular damage

SAFE FLAVOR STRATEGY	KEY RULE
Calamansi + garlic + vinegar + pepper	All four flavors with near-zero Na, K+, phosphate
Dried herbs (oregano, bay leaf, thyme)	Safe at any CKD stage
Toasted garlic (small amount)	Rich flavor; limit to 1 tsp per meal

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CKD PLATE METHOD BY STAGE

Plate proportions shift dramatically as CKD advances. Never use a standard "healthy plate" for Stage 3b or higher.

Stage	Plate Proportions	Key Rules
Stage 1-2	½ vegetables · ¼ whole grain · ¼ lean protein	Standard healthy plate. No restriction needed unless comorbidities present.
Stage 3a-3b	¼ lean protein · ¼ low-K veg · ¼ complex carb · ¼ low-Na foods	Moderate restriction begins. Avoid bagoong, patis, processed meats.
Stage 4-5 (pre-dialysis)	¼ very lean protein (0.6 g/kg) · ½ safe veg (leached) · ¼ white rice/refined carb	Strict limits on K+/P/Na. Leach all root vegetables. No broth.
Dialysis HD/PD	■ high protein (1.1-1.2 g/kg) · ¼ low-K veg (leached) · carb + fluid cautious	MORE protein, STRICTER K+/P/Na/fluid. Dialysis removes protein — do not restrict it.

DAILY NUTRIENT TARGETS BY CKD STAGE

Nutrient	Stage 1-3a	Stage 3b-4	Dialysis HD/PD
Protein	0.8 g/kg/day	0.6-0.8 g/kg/day	1.1-1.2 g/kg/day
Sodium	<2,000 mg/day	<2,000 mg/day	<2,000 mg/day
Potassium	Unrestricted	<2,500 mg/day	<2,000 mg/day
Phosphorus	<900 mg/day	<800 mg/day	<800 mg/day
Fluid	Unrestricted	Depends on urine output	500-750 mL + urine output

BEST PROTEIN SOURCES BY CKD STAGE

Protein Source	Stage 1-3a	Stage 3b-4	Dialysis	Why
Egg white	✓✓✓	✓✓✓	✓✓✓	Very low P, high-quality protein
Chicken breast (skin off)	✓✓✓	✓✓	✓✓✓	Lean, moderate P, versatile
Fish (bangus/tilapia)	✓✓✓	✓✓	✓✓	Omega-3; watch serving size
Pork tenderloin (lean)	✓✓	✓	✓✓	Lower fat than pork belly
Whole egg	✓✓	✓✓	✓✓	Yolk has higher P; limit to 1/day
Organ meats (atay/utak)	✗	✗	✗	Extreme purine + phosphate
Processed meats (tocino/hotdog)	✗	✗	✗	Phosphate preservatives

THE CKD SUNDAY PREP SYSTEM — 3 HOURS, 7 DAYS PROTECTED

Time	Task	Details
Hour 1 9-10 AM	Leach vegetables	Set water to leach kamote, patatas, singkamas, gabi. Start rice cooker. Marinate proteins (vinegar + calamansi + garlic + pepper — no toyo).
Hour 2 10-11 AM	Cook protein batches	Boil chicken/fish in batches — drain ALL cooking liquid immediately. Steam or bake as alternative. Portion 70g (pre-dialysis) or 90g (dialysis) per serving.
Hour 3 11 AM-12 PM	Portion + label containers	Fill containers: protein + rice + vegetable. Label each: Day / Meal (B/L/D/S) / Contents / K+ level. Refrigerate 3-4 days, freeze the rest. Pack go-bag.

4-STEP CONTAINER LABELING SYSTEM

Label every container with 4 pieces of info:
1. **Day** — Mon / Tue / Wed...
2. **Meal** — B (Breakfast) / L (Lunch) / D (Dinner) / S (Snack)
3. **Contents** — Protein + vegetable + carb
4. **K+ level** — LOW / MOD / HIGH (so you know the risk)

ESSENTIAL PREP TOOLS

- Digital food scale (gram-accurate)
- Individual portion containers — 4 sets × 3 days = 12
- Leaching bowls (large, for 10x water volume)
- Kitchen timer for leach timing
- Marker/labels for container ID

SEASONING WITHOUT SODIUM — FILIPINO FLAVORS

Instead of	Use
Toyo (soy sauce)	Calamansi juice + small garlic
Patis (fish sauce)	Vinegar + crushed garlic + tiny amount toyo
Bagoong	Miso paste 1 tsp + calamansi (far lower Na + purines)
MSG / Magic Sarap	Toasted garlic + dried herbs (oregano, bay leaf)
Table salt	Calamansi + pepper + lemon zest

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LEACHING TECHNIQUE — REDUCES POTASSIUM BY 30-50%

Step	Action	Why it matters
Step 1	Peel completely — kamote, gabi, patatas, singkamas	Most K+ is concentrated near the surface/skin
Step 2	Slice thin (3-5 mm thick)	More surface area = more K+ released during soak
Step 3	Soak 2+ hours in 10x warm water — change water once at 1 hour	K+ diffuses from vegetable into water. Discard ALL soak water.
Step 4	Boil in fresh water, drain immediately	NEVER reuse cooking liquid. Final K+ is in that water.

SAFE — Low K+ (no leaching)	Vegetable	Soak Time	K+ Reduction
Sayote · Upo · Ampalaya · Labanos · Sitaw (1 cup max) Bell pepper · Cabbage · Cucumber · Lettuce · Talong Kangkong (½ cup max)	Kamote / sweet potato	4 hrs, change water at 2h	~50%
	Gabi (taro)	3 hours	~45%
	Patatas (potato)	2 hours	~40%
REQUIRE LEACHING or AVOID	Singkamas	2 hours	~35%
	Kamatis	1 hour	~30%
Leach before use: Kamote, Gabi, Patatas, Singkamas, Kamatis			
Avoid (very high K+): Saging/banana (Stage 3+), Spinach, Alugbati, Avocado			

COOKING METHOD RANKINGS (BEST → WORST FOR CKD)

Rank	Method	Rating	Notes
1	Steaming	✓✓✓	No added Na, retains nutrients, no K+ transfer issue
2	Boiling (drain liquid)	✓✓	Leaches K+ into water — always discard cooking water
3	Grilling / Baking	✓✓	No added Na; watch marinades for soy/fish sauce
4	Stir-fry (minimal oil)	✓	Fast; watch sodium from sauces — use calamansi/vinegar only
5	Deep frying	XX	Adds phosphate from breading/batter; avoid whenever possible
6	Pressure cooking	X	Retains ALL minerals; no leaching benefit for K+ reduction

CKD-ADAPTED FILIPINO DISHES

Dish	What to Change	Why
Sinigang	Eat meat only; skip ALL broth	K+ and purines leach into broth
Nilaga	Eat beef/pork/chicken only; discard broth	Same — all K+ in the liquid
Bulalo	Small serving of boiled meat only; no broth at all	Bone broth = highest purine + K+ liquid
Adobo	Vinegar + small garlic + pepper only; skip toyo	Each tbsp toyo = ~1,000 mg Na
Tinola	Chicken meat only; no broth; replace sayote for malunggay	Malunggay = high K+; broth concentrates K+
Paksiw	Vinegar-based = OK; watch portion size	Fish sauce forbidden; vinegar safe
Kare-kare	Eat vegetables + oxtail (no broth); miso instead of bagoong	Bagoong = concentrated Na + purine
Dinuguan	AVOID	Pork blood + organ meat = extreme purine + phosphate
Sisig	AVOID	Organ meat (atay/utak) = extreme purine + phosphate

FILIPINO FAST FOOD — TRAFFIC LIGHT RATINGS

GLOBAL FAST FOOD RULES — APPLY THESE AT EVERY CHAIN:

- Take phosphate binder WITH the first bite of every meal • Water only — no carbonated drinks, softdrinks, or sports drinks
- Remove ALL fried-chicken skin and breading (most phosphate additives are in the coating) • Skip all gravy and broth-based items
- No burgers (phosphate-enriched buns) • When in doubt: skip it

MANG INASAL BEST OPTION	OK TO ORDER: • Pecho (breast) 1 pc — skin completely off • Paa (leg) — skin off • Plain rice 1 cup • Vinegar / calamansi dip (small amount)	AVOID: • Sinigang/soup — high K+/Na broth • Goto / Palabok — organ meat / shrimp • Peanut sauce — high K+ • All softdrinks • Unlimited rice trap
	Best order: 1 pc pecho (skin off) + 1 cup plain rice + water <i>Grilled not fried = no breading = no phosphate additives.</i>	
JOLLIBEE CAUTION	OK TO ORDER: • Chicken Joy 1 pc — skin completely off, no gravy • Plain steamed rice 1 cup • Peach Mango Pie — Stage 1-3 occasional only	AVOID: • Spaghetti — high Na + processed meat • All burgers — phosphate in bun + patty • Palabok — shrimp-based, high P • Jolly Hotdog — processed + phosphate • Gravy — phosphate thickener + very high Na • Peach Float / softdrinks — phosphoric acid
	Best order: 1 pc Chicken Joy (skin off, no gravy) + plain rice + water <i>Chicken Joy breading contains phosphate additives — remove ALL skin and breading.</i>	
MCDONALD'S PH CAUTION	OK TO ORDER: • McChicken patty — remove the bun completely • Plain steamed rice 1 cup • Grilled chicken if available	AVOID: • All burgers — enriched buns = phosphate leavening • Large fries — very high K+/Na • McFlurry / Sundae — dairy + additives, high P • All iced coffees — dairy + sweetener + phosphate • All sodas
	Best order: McChicken patty (bun removed) + plain rice + mineral water <i>Small fries Stage 1-3 occasional only. No sodas.</i>	
KFC PHILIPPINES HIGH RISK	OK TO ORDER: • Original Recipe 1 piece ONLY — skin and breading COMPLETELY removed • Plain rice 1 cup	AVOID: • Gravy — extreme P + Na • Coleslaw — high Na dressing • Twister / Zinger — phosphate-enriched tortilla + bun • Mashed potato — instant mix + gravy = extreme P + Na • Corn on the cob — very high K+ • All sides and all drinks except water
	Best order: 1 pc Original Recipe (all skin and breading stripped) + plain rice + water <i>WARNING: Highest-risk chain. Heavy phosphate additives in all breading. Strip to bare meat.</i>	
CHOWKING CAUTION	OK TO ORDER: • Plain steamed rice 1 cup • Fried chicken 1 pc — skin removed • Tokwa't baboy small serving — limit soy sauce	AVOID: • Halo-halo — very high K+: ube + beans + banana • Siopao — processed pork + high Na dough • Dimsum — high Na + phosphate • Congee/lugaw/arroz caldo — very high Na broth • All noodle dishes — phosphate-enriched + high Na
	Best order: Plain rice + 1 pc fried chicken (skin off) + water <i>Avoid all broth-based dishes.</i>	
KENNY ROGERS ROASTERS CAUTION	OK TO ORDER: • Rotisserie chicken 1 quarter — skin completely off, no sauce • Plain steamed rice 1 cup • Corn on cob ½ cob only (skip if Stage 3+ with K+ restriction)	AVOID: • Macaroni salad — high P: mayo + dairy + high Na • Mashed potato with gravy — extreme P + Na • Coleslaw — high Na dressing • Chicken soup/porridge — very high Na broth • All sauces / dips / marinades — added phosphates + Na
	Best order: Rotisserie quarter (skin off, no sauce) + 1 cup plain rice + water <i>Safer than KFC — roasted not fried, no breading. Danger is in the SIDES.</i>	
GOLDBLOCKS / RED RIBBON BETTER FOR SNACKS	OK TO ORDER: • Plain pancit bihon small serving (watch Na) • Puto 2 pieces occasionally • Chicken + rice meal sets moderate (watch sauce)	AVOID: • Cakes/pastries — phosphate leavening in baking powder • Ensaymada — high P: butter + cheese • Leche flan / custard — very high P: egg yolks + dairy • Fruit salad — high K+: fruit cocktail + cream
	Best order: Puto 2 pcs + plain rice + water <i>Better for snacks than full meals. Avoid ALL dairy-based desserts and baked goods.</i>	

WHAT TO DRINK AT ANY CHAIN

SAFE DRINKS

- Plain mineral / still water — always the best choice
- Unsweetened calamansi juice (no syrup)
- Plain iced tea unsweetened
- Hot black coffee (no milk, no sugar) — mild urate-lowering effect

AVOID COMPLETELY

- All carbonated softdrinks (Coke/Pepsi/Sprite/Royal) — phosphoric acid
- All sweetened iced teas / lemonades (HFCS)
- Fruit juices commercial — high K+ + fructose
- Energy drinks (Red Bull/Sting/C2 Power) — K+ + phosphate
- Sports drinks (Gatorade/Pocari) — high K+
- Iced coffee with milk/creamers — dairy phosphate

CONVENIENCE STORES — 7-ELEVEN / MINISTOP / FAMILYMART

Item	Notes	Stage Safety
Plain white rice (hot counter)	Safest convenience item; 1 cup only	All stages ✓
Hard-boiled egg	1 egg; excellent portable protein; very low P	All stages ✓
Plain crackers (Sky Flakes/Fita original)	2-3 pcs; check label for original low-Na version	All stages ✓
Bottled mineral water	Always choose over any other beverage	All stages ✓
Apple or pear	Lower-K+ fruit; safe emergency snack	All stages ✓
Unsweetened soy milk (small carton)	Moderate P; Stage 1-3 occasional only	Stage 1-3 only
Banana	High K+ — physician clearance required	Stage 1-2 only

ALWAYS AVOID AT CONVENIENCE STORES:

- All instant noodles (Lucky Me/Nissin/Payless) — extreme Na + phosphate in seasoning
- Processed meats (hotdog/longganisa/tocino) — nitrates + phosphate preservatives
- Canned goods (sardines/corned beef) — high Na + phosphate in brine
- Flavored chips — often contain KCl (potassium chloride) salt substitute = fatal in CKD
- Energy/sports drinks (Red Bull/Gatorade/Pocari) — high K+ + phosphate
- Carbonated drinks — phosphoric acid = 100% absorbed
- Dairy desserts (pudding/yogurt/flavored milk) — high phosphate

SURVIVAL MEAL (Convenience Store Emergency): 1 plain rice + 1 hard-boiled egg + 2 crackers + mineral water = very low K+/P/Na. Take phosphate binder with the egg.

CARINDERIA / TURO-TURO GUIDE

USUALLY SAFE:

- Plain white rice
- Inihaw na isda (bangus/tilapia) — no sauce
- Boiled/steamed chicken — no broth served
- Pinakbet small serving — leached veg, miso not bagoong
- Chopsuey with sayote / upo / cabbage / carrots
- Ensaladang talong small serving — no bagoong

ALWAYS AVOID:

- ANY sinigang / nilaga / bulalo / sabaw — skip broth
- Kare-kare with bagoong
- Dinuguan — pork blood + organ meat
- Sisig — organ meat
- Goto / offal dishes
- Processed meat dishes
- Halo-halo

Script to say at carinderia: "Pakihingan ng toyo at bagoong. Wag lagyan ng maraming asin. Para sa kidney ko."

7-DAY MEAL PLAN — CKD STAGE 3b-4 (PRE-DIALYSIS)

Protein 0.6-0.8 g/kg/day | K+ <2,500 mg/day | P <900 mg/day | Na <2,000 mg/day | All proteins = 70 g serving

Day	Breakfast	Lunch	Merienda	Dinner
Mon	1 boiled egg + ½ cup rice + calamansi	Baked chicken 70g + ¾ cup rice + steamed sayote	2 crackers + 1 apple	Steamed tilapia 70g + ½ cup rice + blanched cabbage
Tue	Soft-boiled egg + 1 slice white bread	Tinola chicken 70g (meat only, no broth) + ¾ cup rice	1 pear	Pork tenderloin 70g + ½ cup rice + steamed upo
Wed	Plain champorado ¾ cup (no evap milk)	Steamed fish 70g + ¾ cup rice + sautéed sayote	2 Sky Flakes crackers	Adobo chicken 70g (vinegar-based, no toyo) + ½ cup rice
Thu	1 egg + ½ cup sinangag (no toyo)	Boiled chicken 70g + ¾ cup rice + blanched sitaw (1 cup)	1 small apple	Baked bangus 70g + ½ cup rice + steamed ampalaya
Fri	1 boiled egg + ½ cup plain rice	Tinolang isda 70g (meat only) + ¾ cup rice + sayote	2 crackers + water	Steamed chicken 70g + ½ cup rice + chopsuey (no oyster sauce)
Sat	Soft scrambled egg (1) + ½ cup rice	Paksiw na isda 70g + ¾ cup rice + ensaladang talong	1 pear	Grilled chicken 70g (no marinade) + ½ cup rice + sautéed upo
Sun	1 egg + 1 slice white bread	Chicken breast 70g + ¾ cup rice + steamed labanos	Banana (Stage 1-2 only) or 2 crackers	Baked tilapia 70g + ½ cup rice + blanched ampalaya

7-DAY MEAL PLAN — DIALYSIS HD/PD

Protein 1.1-1.2 g/kg/day | K+ <2,000 mg/day | P <800 mg/day | Na <2,000 mg/day | All proteins = 90 g serving | Fluid restriction applies

Day	Breakfast	Lunch	Merienda	Dinner
Mon	2 boiled eggs + ½ cup rice	Chicken breast 90g (skin off) + ¾ cup rice + steamed sayote	2 crackers + water	Fish 90g + ½ cup rice + blanched cabbage
Tue	2-egg scramble + ½ cup rice	Baked pork tenderloin 90g + ¾ cup rice + steamed upo	1 apple (medium)	Grilled chicken 90g + ½ cup rice + sautéed ampalaya
Wed	1 egg + ¾ cup rice + 1 slice white bread	Fish 90g (steamed) + ¾ cup rice + sayote	2 Sky Flakes	Chicken 90g + ½ cup rice + steamed labanos
Thu	2 boiled eggs + ½ cup rice	Pork tenderloin 90g + ¾ cup rice + steamed sitaw ½ cup	1 pear	Baked bangus 90g + ½ cup rice + chopsuey (no oyster sauce)
Fri	2-egg scramble + ½ cup rice	Chicken breast 90g + ¾ cup rice + blanched cabbage	2 crackers	Tilapia 90g + ½ cup rice + sautéed sayote
Sat	2 eggs + ½ cup sinangag (no toyo)	Baked fish 90g + ¾ cup rice + steamed upo	1 small apple	Chicken 90g + ½ cup rice + blanched ampalaya
Sun	2 boiled eggs + ½ cup rice	Pork 90g + ¾ cup rice + steamed labanos	2 crackers + water	Fish 90g + ½ cup rice + blanched cabbage

THE CKD GO-BAG KIT — NEVER BE CAUGHT WITHOUT A SAFE OPTION

Item	What it is	Why essential
Portioned home-cooked meal (cold pack)	Your leached, portion-controlled prepared meal	Best nutrition; nothing safer at any fast food location
Mineral water 500mL bottle	Still water, no additives	Never rely on fast food drinks; phosphoric acid is everywhere
Phosphate binder (labeled pill case)	In case labeled with meal times	Take with FIRST bite of every meal — no exceptions
Calamansi juice (small bottle, unsweetened)	Flavor safely without Na+	Replaces patis/toyo/soy sauce; zero Na in pure juice
Sky Flakes crackers (2-3 pcs in zip bag)	Safe emergency snack	Low Na, low K+, low P — the safest packaged snack
Apple or pear	Safe low-K+ fruit snack	Emergency snack; all stages safe
Labeled meal prep container	Compartments: Day / Meal / Contents / K+ level	Prevents confusion; enables portion control away from home

PRACTICAL TIPS & FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

Question	Answer
Can I eat delivery food?	With great caution. Mang Inasal pecho (no sauce) + rice = generally acceptable. Avoid all burger delivery, noodle dishes, soups, and any softdrinks.
What if I forgot my phosphate binder?	Call your doctor. Do NOT eat a high-phosphate meal without your binder. Choose rice + egg + water (the survival combo) and take your binder as soon as you get home.
How do I survive a boodle fight or lechon party?	Eat: plain rice (1 cup) + boiled meat (small serving, no broth). Skip: sisig, dinuguan, organ meats, all soups/broth, all softdrinks, beer. Bring your own calamansi water and phosphate binder.
Is restaurant delivery safe?	Generally no — cooking method and sodium content are unknown. If you must order: Mang Inasal pecho delivery is the most reliable safe option. Always skip the sauces.
What about instant noodles in emergencies?	Never. Lucky Me/Nissin seasoning packets contain extreme Na (1,500+ mg per packet) + phosphate additives. Always carry crackers + egg instead.
Can I have merienda from a bakery?	Only plain puto (2 pcs max). Avoid ensaymada (high P butter+cheese), leche flan (high P egg yolk+dairy), all cakes/pastries (phosphate leavening), and all dairy-based baked goods.

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This document was prepared by W. G. M. Rivero, MD, FPCP, DPSN (PRC 0105184) for patient education purposes. It is not a substitute for individualized medical advice. Dietary requirements vary by CKD stage, comorbidities, laboratory values, and medications. Always follow the specific dietary prescription given by your nephrologist.

CKD Meal Prep & Fast Food — Overview Infographic

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MEAL PREP & FAST FOOD FOR CKD PATIENTS ON THE GO

A practical kidney-safe eating system for busy lives

Based on KDIGO 2024 nutrition targets



1 WHY PLANNING MATTERS

⚠️ Potassium spike

Fast food + processed snacks can contain 2,000+ mg potassium in one sitting.

In dialysis patients, serum K may rise by 1–2 mEq/L within hours.

⚠️ Phosphate overload

Phosphate additives are absorbed at ~100%.

Natural food phosphorus is absorbed only about 40–60%.

⚠️ Sodium + fluid overload

A single fast food meal often contains 1,500–2,500 mg sodium.

This can worsen BP, edema, and fluid overload.

★ Meal preparation is a clinical intervention — not just a lifestyle choice.

2 THE CKD PLATE BY STAGE

Stage 1–2:
1/2 vegetables,
1/4 grain, 1/4 protein



Stage 1–3a:
protein 0.8 g/kg/day;
sodium <2,000 mg/day

Stage 3–4:
1/4 lean protein, 1/4 low-potassium vegetables, 1/4 complex carbohydrate, 1/4 low-sodium foods



Stage 3b–4:
protein 0.6–0.8 g/kg/day;
potassium <2,500 mg/day if elevated; phosphorus <900 mg/day

Dialysis (HD/PD):
1/3 high-protein foods, 1/4 low-potassium vegetables, fluid-cautious meals, phosphate binders with meals



Dialysis:
protein 1.1–1.2 g/kg/day;
potassium <2,000 mg/day pre-HD; phosphorus <800 mg/day; fluid 500–750 mL + urine output/day (HD)

5 FAST FOOD SURVIVAL GUIDE — TRAFFIC LIGHT TABLE

	OK / BEST	CAUTION	AVOID
Jollibee	plain rice	1 pc fried chicken no skin, no gravy	spaghetti, burgers, palabok, hotdog, softdrinks, gravy
McDonald's	Better: grilled chicken if available OK: plain rice Only option: 1 pc chicken, skin removed OK: plain rice	McChicken patty only, no bun	burgers, large fries, softdrinks, iced coffee
KFC			gravy, coleslaw, burgers, mashed potato, corn
Chowking	plain rice	small tokwa't baboy, 1 pc fried chicken no skin	halo-halo, siopao, siomai, congee, noodles
Mang Inasal	Best option. Good choice: pecho, chicken breast OK: plain rice, 1 cup only	acceptable: paa with skin removed	sinigang, goto, palabok, peanut-based sauce

GENERAL RULES: Always take your phosphate binder with fast food meals.
Avoid carbonated drinks, gravy, soup-based items, and fried chicken skin.

3 THE CKD SUNDAY PREP SYSTEM — 3 HOURS, 7 DAYS PROTECTED

1 Saturday evening: Shop smart

- Lean proteins, low-potassium vegetables, white rice
- Avoid processed meats
- Check ingredient lists for 'phosphate', 'sodium phosphate', or E3xx additives

2 Sunday morning: Start leaching

- Peel, slice, soak potatoes, kamote, gabi.

3 Sunday midday: Batch cook proteins

- Baked chicken breast, grilled or steamed tilapia, boiled eggs.
- Portion guide: 60–80 g per meal pre-dialysis; 90–120 g per meal dialysis.

4 Sunday afternoon: Prep vegetables + carbs

- Blanch sayote, upo, patola.
- Portion cooked white rice 1/2–3/4 cup.

5 Weekday: Assembly only

- Reheat and add phosphate binder WITH meals if prescribed.

Useful tools

- Glass containers
- Divided containers
- Insulated lunch bag
- Freezer bags
- Food scale
- Measuring cups

4 LEACHING — HOW TO LOWER POTASSIUM

1 Peel completely

2 Slice thin (2–5 mm)

3 Soak in 10x volume warm water for at least 2 hours and change water once

4 Boil in fresh water and drain

Final result:
May reduce potassium by 30–50% in root vegetables.

⚠️ Never use the soaking or boiling water for soup, broth, or sauces.

✓ Safe without leaching:

- sayote • upo • patola
- white cabbage • toge
- labanos • pipino

⚠️ Require leaching or strict caution:

- kamote • gabi • potato • kangkong • malunggay
- squash • mongo • tomato • banana • avocado

6 CONVENIENCE STORE + CARINDERIA RESCUE OPTIONS

A. Convenience store — safer picks

Plain white rice

Hard-boiled egg

Plain crackers

Bottled water

Apple or pear

Avoid
• Instant noodles • Processed meats • Canned goods
• Chips • Sports drinks • Carbonated drinks
• Flavored nuts • Dairy desserts

B. Carinderia — safer picks

Plain rice

Tinolang manok (eat chicken, skip broth)

Pinakbet small serving no bagoong

Grilled fish

Nilaga (meat only, skip broth + potato)

Ensaladang talong

Plain tokwa (small serving)

Use caution:
adobo, sinigang, kare-kare, fried fish, chopsuey

Avoid:
tocino, longganisa, hotdog, dinuguan, all soups as main dish, bagoong, mongo guisado, dishes heavy in tomatoes

"Pakihingan ng toyo at bagoong. Wag lagyan ng maraming asin. Gusto ko ng malinis na pagkain para sa kidney ko."



7 THE CKD GO-BAG FOOD KIT

One portion of prepped protein

2–3 plain crackers

A small apple or pear

500 mL mineral water

Phosphate binders

Other mealtime medications

Calamansi or vinegar dip sachet

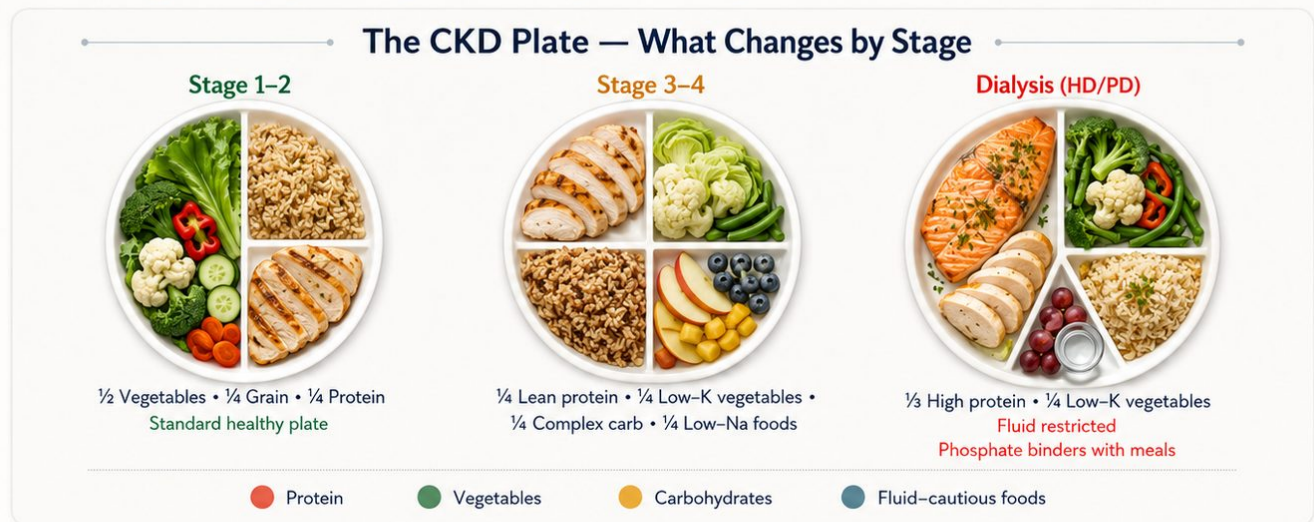
Dialysis schedule Mon–Wed–Fri 6:00 AM
Emergency Contact 0917-123-4567

★ BEST STRATEGY: PREP EARLY, PORTION CAREFULLY, AVOID PHOSPHATE ADDITIVES, AND CHOOSE THE SIMPLEST MEAL WHEN EATING OUT.

A complete visual guide to eating well with kidney disease: safe fast-food choices, meal prepping on a budget, and renal diet principles for Filipino patients.

The CKD Plate Method — by Stage

Before building a meal prep system, understand what your plate should look like. This varies significantly by CKD stage and whether you are on dialysis.



The plate proportions shift dramatically as CKD advances. Dialysis patients need more protein (lost during sessions) but strict limits on potassium, phosphorus, sodium, and fluid — the opposite of pre-dialysis CKD.

 Stage 1–3a targets	 Stage 3b–4 targets	 Dialysis (HD/PD) targets
- Protein: 0.8 g/kg/day - Sodium: <2,000 mg/day - Potassium: generally unrestricted unless elevated - Phosphorus: avoid additives, moderate natural phos - Fluid: no restriction unless edema or hypertension	- Protein: 0.6–0.8 g/kg/day (discuss with nephrologist) - Sodium: <2,000 mg/day - Potassium: <2,500 mg/day if K+ elevated - Phosphorus: <900 mg/day, avoid all additives - Fluid: restrict if edema present	- Protein: 1.1–1.2 g/kg/day (losses in dialysis) - Sodium: <2,000 mg/day - Potassium: <2,000 mg/day pre-HD - Phosphorus: <800 mg/day + binders with all meals - Fluid: 500–750 mL + urine output/day (HD)

Build a kidney-safe plate at home or when eating out — the right balance of protein, starch, and low-potassium vegetables at a glance.

Ordering Smart at the Carinderia

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Practical tips for Filipino patients eating at local eateries: what to order, what to limit, and how to ask for modifications.